ARIA

Inclusion Toolkit

What is it for?

Accessible Rich Internet Applications (ARIA) is a set of roles and attributes that make the web more accessible for users with disabilities. ARIA adds to HTML. It lets common web app interactions be passed to assistive technologies when there is no other way to do this.

Note: Not using ARIA is always better than using ARIA badly. Bad use of ARIA can make a website impossible to use for people who use assistive technology. ARIA attributes should only be used when semantic HTML can't do the job.

How to support it

- `aria-label` & `aria-labelledby`: Adds an accessible label to elements that do not have visible text. For example, a search button with only an icon should include an `aria-label` clarifying it. Use it on interactive elements or landmarks, not plain divs or text
- `aria-hidden`: Hides elements from screen readers without removing them visually. This is ideal for decorative or redundant elements
- ARIA roles add semantic meaning to content. These should be avoided when there is semantic HTML that can provide the same meaning (for example, don't use `role=listitem` and instead use an `<li>`)

Useful Links

- W3C - Rules of ARIA
- Mozilla: ARIA
- List of ARIA attributes
- Accessibility essentials every front-end developer should know
- What I Wish Someone Told Me When I Was Getting Into ARIA
- List of ARIA roles